

Proposal for Emoji: Liver

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Identification

Suggested name: Liver

Suggested keywords: hepatic; anatomy; organ; bile; metabolism; laboratory test; transplant; donation

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The paradigm is a full, asymmetrical liver with a domed major lobe, a tapering lesser lobe, a visible lobe seam, and an optional small gallbladder cue beneath the lower edge. Vendors may change the angle, shading, and color, or omit the gallbladder, while preserving the broad lobed silhouette at emoji size.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Not applicable. The proposal relies on the direct literal meaning of the liver.

B. Use in sequences

Liver can combine with existing emoji to create distinct messages:

- Liver + Test Tube or Bar Chart: a liver function test or result.
- Liver + Pill or Warning: medicine-related liver monitoring or a liver safety warning.
- Liver + Hospital or People: liver transplantation, donation, follow-up, or support.

These are established organ-specific contexts. MedlinePlus describes liver function tests, including their use in monitoring medicine effects, and NIDDK describes liver transplantation and living-donor transplantation.

Sources:

- <https://medlineplus.gov/lab-tests/liver-function-tests/>
- <https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/liver-disease/liver-transplant>

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. No current emoji or reliable emoji sequence identifies the liver. Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain identify different body parts; Cut of Meat and Beans do not reliably identify a liver; and general medical emoji can express testing, treatment, or care without supplying the missing body-site term. Liver therefore adds a distinct literal semantic building block for ordinary messages that explicitly identify the organ.

Current Unicode emoji list: <https://www.unicode.org/emoji/charts/full-emoji-list.html>

D. Distinctiveness

The liver's broad, low, asymmetrical silhouette separates it from the taller Anatomical Heart, paired Lungs, and rounded Brain. Unequal lobes and a visible lobe seam remain present in both 18x18 versions; the color design adds an optional green gallbladder cue. Against the closest object confusers, the form is a single full organ rather than a food cut or a pair of seeds. The black-and-white design uses a white interior and strong outline instead of a featureless filled shape.

Liver	Anatomical Heart	Lungs	Brain	Cut of Meat	Beans
Color 72 					
Color 18 					
B/W 72 					
B/W 18 					

E. Expected usage level

Liver is used directly in general anatomy, laboratory testing, medication monitoring, transplantation, donation, food, and education. MedlinePlus maintains dedicated pages for liver diseases and liver function tests, while NIDDK maintains patient guidance dedicated to liver transplantation. The five frequency figures below measure the term directly; Google Trends and Google Books use Unicode's reference term `elephant` for comparison.

Sources:

- <https://medlineplus.gov/liverdiseases.html>
- <https://medlineplus.gov/lab-tests/liver-function-tests/>
- <https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/liver-disease/liver-transplant>

Google Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google reports about 183,000 results for the unquoted term liver .

Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?q=liver&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>

The screenshot shows a Google search interface for the term "liver". At the top, the Google logo is on the left, and the search bar contains "liver". To the right of the search bar are icons for clearing the search, voice search, image search, and a magnifying glass. Further right are icons for settings, sharing, and a grid of apps, followed by a "Sign in" button.

Below the search bar, a horizontal menu includes "All", "Images", "Shopping", "Videos", "Forums", "Short videos", "More", and "Tools". The "Tools" menu is open, showing options: "Any time", "All results", "Advanced Search", and "About 183,000 results (0.19s)".

The "AI Overview" section is expanded, displaying a summary: "The liver is the largest internal organ in the human body, located in the upper right side of the abdomen. It performs over 500 vital jobs, including filtering blood, making bile to digest food, and storing energy." Below this is a "Key Functions" section with a "Show more" button.

Search results are listed below. The first result is from Cleveland Clinic, titled "Liver: Where It's Located, Function & Anatomy", dated Sep 26, 2025. The second result is from Wikipedia, titled "Liver", with a brief description: "The liver is a major metabolic organ exclusively found in vertebrates, which performs many essential biological functions such as detoxification of the organism".

Below the search results is a "People also ask" section with four questions, each with a dropdown arrow: "What are the first signs of a bad liver?", "What is the best drink to flush your liver?", "How do I fix liver problems?", and "Where do you feel liver pain?".

At the bottom, there is an "Images" section.

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google Video Search reports about 72,400,000 results.

Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?tbm=vid&q=liver&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>

liver

✕

🔊

🔄

🔍

Settings

Sign in

AllImagesBooksNewsVideosShoppingMoreTools

www.youtube.com › watch

How The Liver Works

For more information about how the liver works cle.clinic/4wVcJJE The liver is a large organ in

YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Aug 12, 2024

4 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Chronic Liver Disease - Yale Medicine Explains

For more information on liver disease or #YaleMedicine, visit: https:// www.yalemedicine.org/conditions/liver-transplant or ...

YouTube · Yale Medicine · May 2, 2026

3 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Anatomy and Physiology of the Liver, Animation

the proper hepatic artery carrying oxygenated blood from the aorta, and · the hepatic portal vein carrying venous drainage from most of the ...

YouTube · Allila Medical Media · May 1, 2023

5 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Liver Patient Education Videos: Video 2 The Liver English

At Stanford Medicine Children's Health, our team of pediatric liver doctors (hepatologists) are leaders in treating complex pediatric liver ...

YouTube · Stanford Medicine Children's Health · May 30, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch

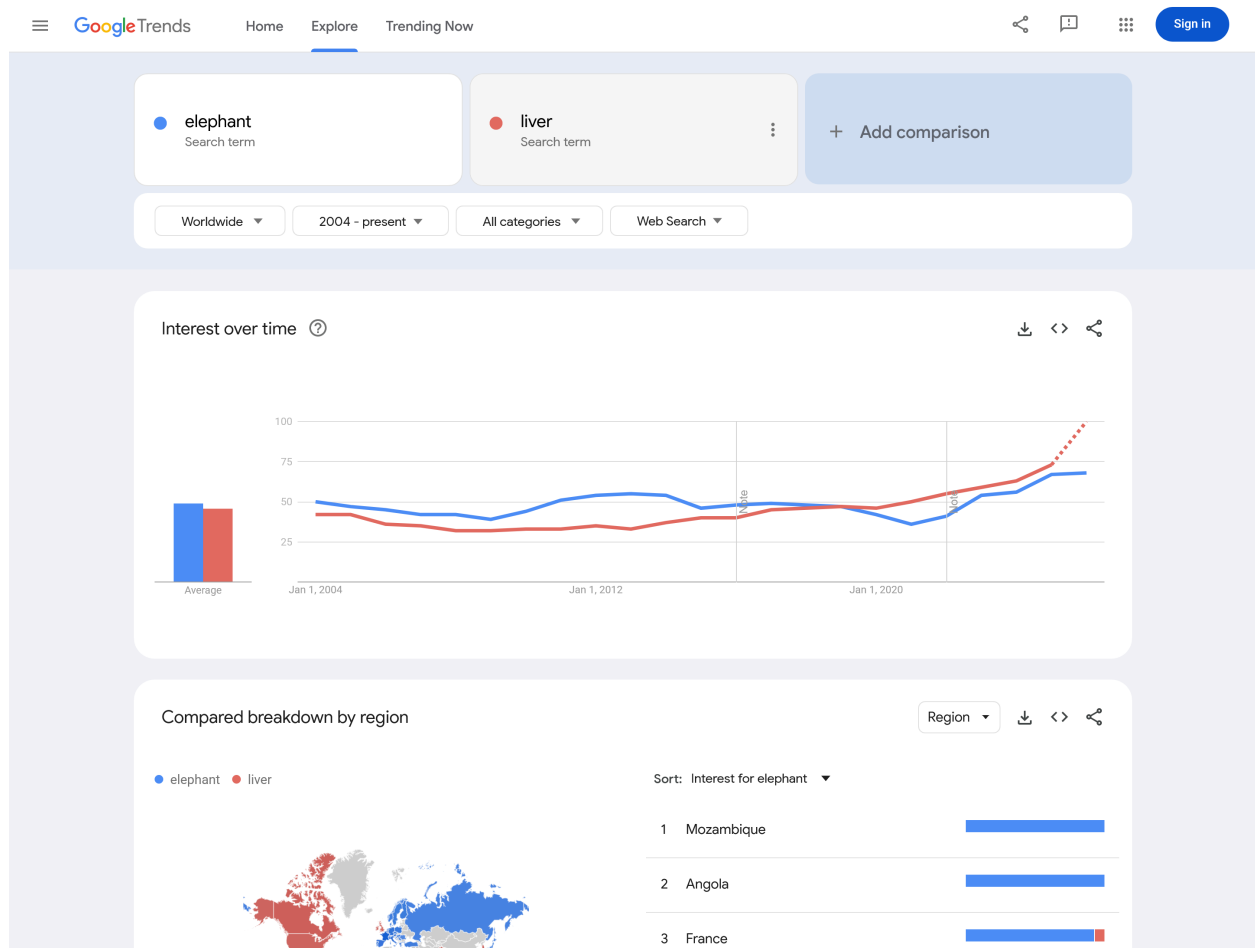
Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors ...

Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors, Symptoms,

Google Trends - Web Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2004-present, and Web Search. Liver and elephant have comparable average interest across the full period, and liver exceeds elephant in the most recent portion of the graph.

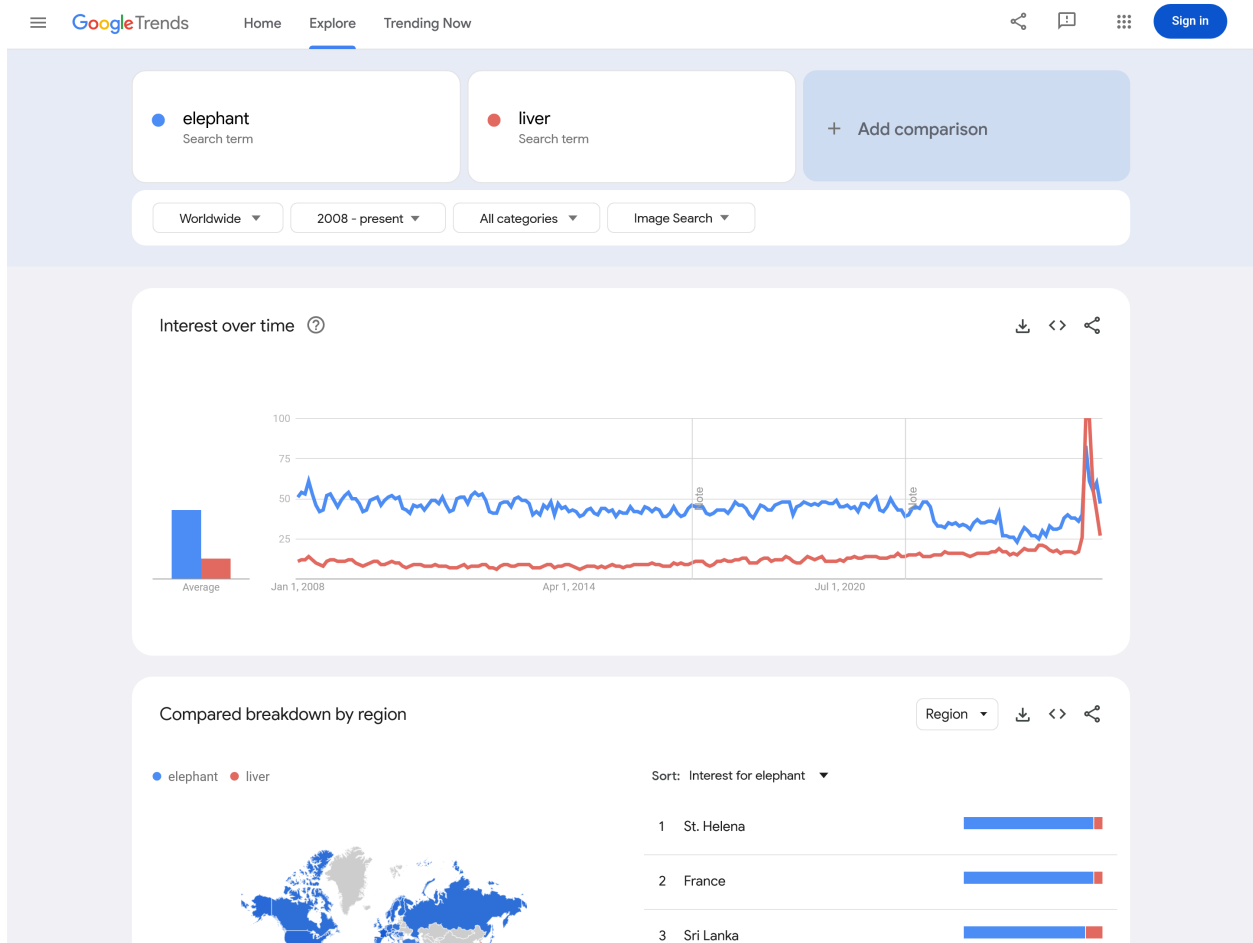
Reproducible query: <https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&q=elephant,liver>



Google Trends - Image Search

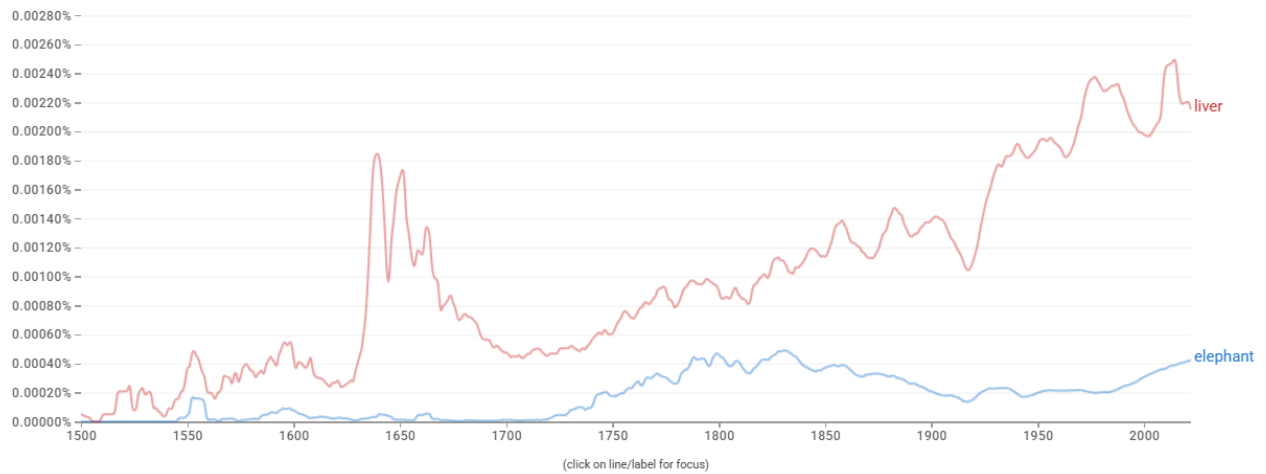
Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2008-present, and Image Search. Liver remains below elephant in average image-search interest while showing sustained worldwide use throughout the period and a pronounced recent peak.

Reproducible query: https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all_2008&gprop=images&q=elephant,liver



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Liver substantially exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage. Reproducible query: https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Cliver&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Liver is independently useful and is not proposed to complete an anatomy set.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or a high-frequency pictograph in another system.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already represented

The strongest substitute is a short sequence such as Hospital + Test Tube, but that sequence means medical testing generally and cannot identify which body site is being discussed. Cut of Meat and Beans are also ambiguous substitutes because they primarily encode food. No current emoji or short sequence supplies the literal liver term.

B. Overly specific

Liver is a broad anatomical entity used across everyday health, laboratory, transplant, donation, food, and education messages. It is not a disease, procedure, specialty, campaign, organization, or brand.

C. Open-ended

Liver stands on its own direct usage, recognizable paradigm, and missing semantic function. Encoding it would not require Unicode to continue a series or complete an anatomy taxonomy.

D. Transient

Liver is a durable term rather than a temporary event or campaign. The embedded Ngram covers 1500-2022, and the current MedlinePlus and NIDDK resources document continuing laboratory and transplant uses.

E. Faulty comparison

The case does not depend on the existence, importance, or acceptance of another emoji. Existing anatomical emoji are used only as visual and semantic comparisons; Liver is supported by its own usage and its own expressive gap.

Other Information

Essential design cues are one broad asymmetrical silhouette, unequal lobes, and a lobe seam that remains visible at 18x18. A small gallbladder, shading, highlight, angle, and exact red-brown tone are optional vendor choices and must not carry the meaning alone. Vendors should avoid a generic rectangular food cut or a featureless filled oval.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>